

Midyear Kit

See where you are, make a realistic plan, and feel confident about the rest of the year.

You don't need the whole kit. Start on page 2.

Page 2 helps you pick the one problem that's loudest this week and sends you to one page. Finish that page and you're done for now. Come back for the others when you need them.

- | | | |
|---|---|-------------|
|  | Choose your starting point
<i>"Where do I even begin?"</i> | page 2 |
|  | My midyear look-back
<i>A page your child fills in, so you both see how far you've come.</i> | page 3 |
|  | Keep, Adjust, or Replace
<i>"What actually needs to change for the second half of our year?"</i> | page 4 |
|  | Your Records Rescue Check
<i>"What have I kept, and what am I missing?"</i> | pages 5–6 |
|  | Your Finish-the-Year Map
<i>"Can we finish what we planned without making every day miserable?"</i> | pages 7–8 |
|  | A Week That Fits Your Family
<i>"How do I fit school around the life we actually have?"</i> | pages 9–10 |
|  | The Weekly Finish
<i>"How do I keep this from piling up again?"</i> | pages 11–12 |

Every piece has a filled-in example, so you can see how it works first. Print only what you need, or read it on your phone and jot answers on paper. Already keep records in a planner, binder or app? Keep using them; nothing here asks you to copy them. The records pages are an organizational aid, not legal advice. They don't tell you what your state requires.

Choose your starting point

“Where do I even begin?”

Pick the sentence that sounds most like this week. Go to that one page and finish it. That’s a success. The rest of the kit will be here when you need it.

WHICH ONE SOUNDS LIKE YOU?

- | | | | |
|---|---|---|------------|
| ☐ <i>“One subject keeps getting pushed off, or ends in tears.”</i> | → | Keep, Adjust, or Replace
Recommended first win: one change you can try this week. | page 4 |
| ☐ <i>“My records are scattered. I’m not sure what I have.”</i> | → | Records Rescue Check
Find what you have and where it lives. Pick one thing to start. | pages 5–6 |
| ☐ <i>“We’ll never finish everything we planned.”</i> | → | Finish-the-Year Map
See what it would take, then pick the lightest option. | pages 7–8 |
| ☐ <i>“Our week is too crowded to fit school in.”</i> | → | A Week That Fits Your Family
Put in what can’t move first, then fit learning around it. | pages 9–10 |
| ☐ <i>“I want to see how far we’ve come.”</i> | → | My midyear look-back
Your child looks back at the year, with your help. | page 3 |

Not sure? Start with Keep, Adjust, or Replace on page 4. It’s the quickest way to feel a difference this week. **Once things feel steadier**, the Weekly Finish (pages 11–12) helps keep it from piling up again.

Short on time tonight? Try this route, about 10 minutes

Three small steps, one page each, in order. Stop after any of them and you’ve still done something useful.

1

Look back

Read the look-back questions on page 3. Ask your child tonight or tomorrow.

2

One adjustment

On page 4, fill in just one row and pick one change to try.

3

One record

On page 5, pick one record to start keeping from this week.

Already keep records?

Good. Check what you have; don’t copy it. Every page lets you write “in the planner” or “in the binder” and move on.

Your week, your days

Nothing here assumes Monday to Friday. Write in the days you actually school, and end your week on whatever day works.



My midyear look-back

Halfway through the year. Draw, write, or tell a grown-up what to write.

My first name _____ Grade _____ Date _____

Draw something you did this year

My favorite book so far

The hardest thing I did

Something I want to learn next

The work I'm proudest of

How my year feels so far



For grown-ups: let your child write or draw, or write down what they say. Sharing it? First names only, and no photos of faces.



Keep, Adjust, or Replace

“What actually needs to change for the second half of our year?”

Look at courses and routines before you spend money on new curriculum or rebuild the whole schedule. Most things only need an adjustment. One row is enough to start.

HOW TO USE

- 1 Start with the one course or routine that keeps slipping.
- 2 Answer the two questions for it.
- 3 Name the problem: material, pace, timing or amount.
- 4 Pick one change to try next week.

COURSE OR ROUTINE	WHAT IS HELPING MY CHILD LEARN?	WHAT REPEATEDLY GETS POSTPONED?	THE PROBLEM IS	DECISION
course for: _____			☐ Material ☐ Pace ☐ Timing ☐ Amount	☐ Keep ☐ Adjust ☐ Replace ☐ Pause / Stop
course for: _____			☐ Material ☐ Pace ☐ Timing ☐ Amount	☐ Keep ☐ Adjust ☐ Replace ☐ Pause / Stop
course for: _____			☐ Material ☐ Pace ☐ Timing ☐ Amount	☐ Keep ☐ Adjust ☐ Replace ☐ Pause / Stop
routine for: _____			☐ Material ☐ Pace ☐ Timing ☐ Amount	☐ Keep ☐ Adjust ☐ Replace ☐ Pause / Stop
routine for: _____			☐ Material ☐ Pace ☐ Timing ☐ Amount	☐ Keep ☐ Adjust ☐ Replace ☐ Pause / Stop

One change to try next week

I'll check back on _____

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

Course: *Handwriting*

Helping: *short copywork she likes*

Postponed: *almost every day, after lunch*

Problem: *timing* • Decision: *Adjust*

Try: *do it first thing, before math*

Check back: *in 2 weeks*

Material is the book or program. **Pace** is how fast you move through it. **Timing** is when in the day or week it happens. **Amount** is how much you try to do at once. Only “material” usually means buying something new. **Pause / Stop** is a real choice too: sometimes setting an optional activity aside is the right change.

ONE PAGE DONE IS A SUCCESS



Your Records Rescue Check

“What have I kept, and what am I missing?”

Check what you already have; don't copy it. If a record lives in a planner, binder, folder or app, just write where it lives. The example is on the next page.

OPTIONAL • IF YOU KNOW WHERE TO LOOK

Which records you keep depends on where you live. If you know where to look (your state's education department website, HSLDA at hsllda.org, or our free state guides at myhomeschoolscribe.com/states/), note what it mentions. If not, skip this for now; the rest of the page works without it.

☐ I looked up my state's rules. Records they mention: _____

STEP 1 • WHAT YOU HAVE

Records many homeschool families keep

Tick one box per row. More than one child? Write initials, or “all”. **Need to check:** it might be somewhere. **Not for us:** you don't keep it, and that's fine.

RECORD	FOR (INITIALS)	HAVE IT	PARTIAL	MISSING	NEED TO CHECK	NOT FOR US	WHERE IT LIVES
Attendance Which days you held school		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Hours or time How long, by day or by subject		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Reading log Books read or read aloud, with dates		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Work samples / portfolio A few pieces or photos from each subject		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Course of study Subjects, plus the books and materials you use		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Test or evaluation results Only if you use them		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Other: _____ Anything else you want to keep		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

STEP 2 • WHAT TO FIX FIRST

Up to three things I'll fix first (one is enough)

Missing? Start it this week, from today on. **Partial?** Note where the rest is, then keep it in one place from now on. **Need to check?** Look when you have a minute; it may not be missing at all.

#	WHAT I'LL FIX	FIRST STEP	BY WHEN
1			
2			
3			

Good to know: this checklist is an organizational aid, not legal advice. It doesn't tell you what your state requires.



Records Rescue Check: example

“What have I kept, and what am I missing?”

The same page, filled in by a made-up family with two children. Yours will look different.

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

☒ I looked up my state's rules. Records they mention: *in my notes*

RECORD	FOR (INITIALS)	HAVE IT	PARTIAL	MISSING	NEED TO CHECK	NOT FOR US	WHERE IT LIVES
Attendance Which days you held school	<i>all</i>	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	<i>Paper planner, kitchen shelf</i>
Hours or time How long, by day or by subject	<i>all</i>	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	<i>Planner, first 6 weeks; not since</i>
Reading log Books read or read aloud, with dates	<i>M</i>	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	<i>Nowhere yet (L keeps her own list)</i>
Work samples / portfolio A few pieces or photos from each subject	<i>all</i>	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	<i>Phone photos and the art bin</i>
Course of study Subjects, plus the books and materials you use	<i>all</i>	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	<i>Notes app on my phone</i>
Test or evaluation results Only if you use them	<i>—</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	<i>We don't use them</i>
Other: field trips Anything else you want to keep	<i>all</i>	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	<i>Maybe on the fridge calendar</i>

Up to three things I'll fix first

#	WHAT I'LL FIX	FIRST STEP	BY WHEN
1	<i>M's reading log</i>	<i>List the books on the shelf he's finished</i>	<i>This Friday</i>
2	<i>Hours, from now on</i>	<i>Write each day's time in the planner again</i>	<i>Starting Monday</i>
3	<i>Work samples</i>	<i>Pick 2 per subject from phone photos into one album</i>	<i>In 2 weeks</i>

What a good result looks like

Not every box ticked. One to three next steps, each with a date. Hours after week 6 were never written down, so this family starts fresh on Monday instead of guessing.

Keep it going

Once a week, the Weekly Finish (pages 11–12) is a quick check that these records are still current.

Good to know: this checklist is an organizational aid, not legal advice. It doesn't tell you what your state requires.



Your Finish-the-Year Map

“Can we finish what we planned without making every day miserable?”

See what it would take to finish your year on your schedule, course by course. Then compare three ways to make it lighter.

HOW TO USE

- 1 Write your finish date, school days a week and breaks.
- 2 Count the school weeks you have left.
- 3 For each course: lessons left ÷ weeks.
- 4 Too many? Try A, B or C and pick one.

STEP 1 • YOUR CALENDAR

Finish date I'd like _____ School days a week _____ Weeks until then _____

Breaks before then _____ Break weeks _____

School weeks available (weeks until then – break weeks) _____

STEP 2 • COURSE BY COURSE

This works best for courses with numbered lessons, like math, phonics or spelling. For projects, essays or interest-led subjects, write the milestones left instead (for example, “2 essays, 1 project”). A fraction like 4.5 a week? Alternate: 4 one week, 5 the next.

COURSE	LESSONS IN THE PLAN	LESSONS DONE	LESSONS LEFT (PLAN – DONE)	SCHOOL WEEKS AVAILABLE	LESSONS A WEEK (LEFT ÷ WEEKS)	HOW IT FEELS
						☐ OK ☐ Tight ☐ Too much
						☐ OK ☐ Tight ☐ Too much
						☐ OK ☐ Tight ☐ Too much
						☐ OK ☐ Tight ☐ Too much
						☐ OK ☐ Tight ☐ Too much

STEP 3 • COMPARE YOUR OPTIONS

A A later finish date

New finish date _____
 School weeks available _____
 Lessons a week _____

B More days a week

Days a week _____ → _____
 Lessons a week (same) _____
 Lessons a day (week ÷ days) _____

C A lighter workload

☐ Combine review lessons
☐ Skip what they already know
☐ Decide to finish it next year
 Lessons left now _____ → _____
 Lessons a week _____

The option I'll try: ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ A mix I'll look again on _____

Your plan, not a standard. This map doesn't tell you how many days or hours your state counts. Teaching two children together can save you time, but each child still has the same lessons left.



Finish-the-Year Map: example

“Can we finish what we planned without making every day miserable?”

A made-up family works through the map. Math looks tight, so they compare A, B and C for math before changing anything.

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

Finish date I'd like *end of May* School days a week *4* Weeks until then *24*

Breaks before then *2 weeks at the holidays, 1 for a family trip, 1 in spring* Break weeks *4*

School weeks available $24 - 4 = 20$

COURSE	LESSONS IN THE PLAN	LESSONS DONE	LESSONS LEFT (PLAN - DONE)	SCHOOL WEEKS AVAILABLE	LESSONS A WEEK (LEFT ÷ WEEKS)	HOW IT FEELS
Math	150	52	98	20	$4.9 \approx 5$	☒ Tight
Reading	120	70	50	20	2.5	☒ OK
History	90	30	60	20	3	☒ OK
Science	36	12	24	20	1.2	☒ OK
Spelling	160	50	110	20	5.5	☒ Too much

Math: $98 \div 20 = 4.9$, so about **5 lessons a week**. We've been doing 4, so we're a little behind our own plan. Here is math through each option:

A A later finish date

New finish date *2 weeks later*

School weeks available *22*

Lessons a week $98 \div 22 \approx 4.5$

B More days a week

Days a week $4 \rightarrow 5$

Lessons a week (same) *5*

Lessons a day (week ÷ days) *1 a day*

C A lighter workload

☒ Combine review lessons

☐ Skip what they already know

☐ Decide to finish it next year

Lessons left now $98 \rightarrow 90$

Lessons a week $90 \div 20 = 4.5$

The option I'll try: ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☒ A mix *C now (8 review lessons combined). A only if we need it. Look again after the holidays.*

What 4.5 a week looks like: alternate 4-lesson and 5-lesson weeks. Over 20 weeks, $10 \times 4 + 10 \times 5 = 90$, exactly what's left after C. On 4 school days, a 5-lesson week has one day with two short lessons.

4

5

4

5

4

5

4

5

4

5

Reading the result

“Too much” just marks the course that needs a decision. Spelling at 5.5 might be a C. Teaching it to two children together saves your time, but each still has 110 lessons left. Writing is essays, so it gets milestones instead: *2 essays, 1 project.*

Your plan, not a standard

This map measures against the plan you made, not against any rule. It doesn't tell you how many days or hours your state counts.



A Week That Fits Your Family

“How do I fit school around the life we actually have?”

Start with what can't move. Then fit learning into the space that's left. Use any days you like. Two examples are on the next page.

HOW TO USE

- 1 Write your days across the top, any day first.
- 2 Fill in what can't move: work, co-op, appointments, meals.
- 3 Add learning blocks. Mark each N, A or T.
- 4 Two N's in the same box? Move one. Then decide what moves when the week changes.

F fixed **N** needs me **A** works alone **T** together · Week of _____

WRITE YOUR DAYS →	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7
Early morning							
Morning							
Midday							
Afternoon							
Evening							

Done together

Morning basket, read-alouds, co-op class: things everyone does at once.

When the week changes

Move: which lessons slide to the next home day?

Shorten: what can be a short version?

Carry forward: what waits for next week?



A Week That Fits: two examples

“How do I fit school around the life we actually have?”

The same made-up family, two different weeks. Fixed things go in first; learning fits around them. Count the N's: no box has two children needing the parent at once.

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

Example 1 • a mostly-at-home week, weekend off

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Morning	T Morning basket	T Morning basket	T Morning basket	T Morning basket	T Library trip	F Soccer	
Late morning	N Phonics, younger A Math, older	N Phonics, younger A Math, older	N Phonics, younger A Math, older	N Phonics, younger A Math, older	N Math review		
Midday	F Lunch, outside	F Lunch, outside	F Lunch, outside	F Lunch, outside	F Lunch, outside		
Afternoon	T Read-aloud, science	F My work calls A kids read	T Read-aloud, science	F My work calls A kids read	T Nature walk		

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

Example 2 • a work-and-co-op week that starts on Tuesday and uses Saturday

	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN	MON
Morning	F Work from home 8–12	F Work from home 8–12	F Co-op 9–2	F Work from home 8–12	T Morning basket		F Work from home 8–12
Late morning	A Math, writing on their own	A Reading on their own	F Co-op	A Math on their own	N Math, younger A Writing, older		A Reading
Midday	F Lunch	F Lunch	F Co-op lunch	F Lunch	F Lunch		F Lunch
Afternoon	N Phonics, younger	T History, science	A Rest, reading	T Read-aloud	T Science project	T Talk about the week	N Check math
Late day		F Swim 4:00		F Piano 3:30			

When the week changes: Co-op runs late on Thursday, so math moves to Saturday. Science is short this week (one experiment). The history chapter carries forward to next week.

F fixed **N** needs me **A** works alone **T** together



The Weekly Finish (any day you end your week)

“How do I keep this from piling up again?”

A short check at the end of your school week, whatever day that is: close out this week, set up the next.

HOW TO USE

1 Pick the day your school week ends.

2 Go top to bottom and tick each line.

3 Already keep these records somewhere? Just tick the line.

4 The back page (12) is optional.

Week of _____ Student(s) _____

☐ **Attendance and time**
logged, or already in the planner?

☐ **Completed work and reading**
what got done this week

☐ **Work samples saved**
1 or 2 picks, dated

☐ **Unfinished lessons**
moved to which day?

☐ **Next week's priorities**
the top 3

☐ **What went well that I don't want to forget?**

EXAMPLE • MADE-UP NUMBERS

☒ **Attendance and time**
logged, or already in the planner?
4 days, all in the planner already

☒ **Completed work and reading**
what got done this week
Math 31–34, Writing journal, finished Charlotte's Web

☒ **Work samples saved**
1 or 2 picks, dated
Fraction drawing, nature-walk photo

☒ **Unfinished lessons**
moved to which day?
Math 35 → next school day

☒ **Next week's priorities**
the top 3
Essay part 2, library books due, co-op project

☒ **What went well that I don't want to forget?**
The whole lunch was about fractions, and nobody asked.



OPTIONAL

Weekly Finish, back: records as you go

Only if you don't already keep these. If your planner, binder or app already has them, skip this page. If your Rescue Check found a gap, this is one simple place to start.

Student _____ Week of ____ / ____ / ____

Attendance and time (write in your own days)

DAY	PRESENT	SUBJECTS AND ACTIVITIES	TIME
	☐		
	☐		
	☐		
	☐		
	☐		
	☐		
	☐		
Total time this week			

Reading log

TITLE	FINISHED

Portfolio picks

SAMPLE OR PHOTO	SUBJECT	DATE	STORED
			☐ Binder ☐ Photo ☐ Folder
			☐ Binder ☐ Photo ☐ Folder
			☐ Binder ☐ Photo ☐ Folder

What makes a good pick: a first try and a later one in the same subject, side by side. Something your child is proud of. A photo of hands-on work. Write the date on it and one line about what it shows.

Course of study notes

Which books, units or lessons each subject covered this week.

Good to know: this page is an organizational aid, not legal advice. It doesn't tell you what your state requires.



Or let HomeSchool Scribe carry the records

Everything in this kit works on paper. A lot of midyear stress comes from piecing records back together. If you'd rather not, HomeSchool Scribe keeps them as you go on your iPhone or iPad. Here is how each piece lines up with the app.

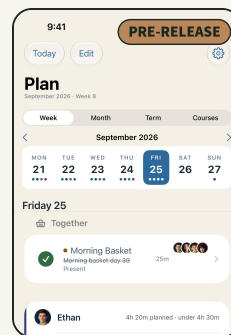
FROM THIS KIT	IN HOMESCHOOL SCRIBE
Records Rescue Check	Attendance and hours, reading log, portfolio and course of study all print as PDFs.
Finish-the-Year Map and Keep, Adjust, or Replace, once you've decided	Plan a course once: pick the days, and lessons lay themselves out around breaks. Change your mind later and edit the course.
A Week That Fits Your Family	Name your co-op or class days, and lessons land on home days. On an away day, one tap marks everyone present and logs the day.
Routines and outside commitments	Log real time. Routines and co-op count too.
The Weekly Finish	Check off a lesson and the student is marked present and the lesson's minutes are logged as hours.

Starting midyear? Add up to 24 photos you already have to the portfolio at once, dated from the photos. Photograph or paste a book's contents page and start at the lesson you're on.

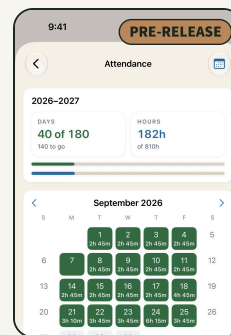
FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

The Demo Family: made-up sample data, not a real family

The Hales of "Maple Lane Academy" are a made-up family we built to show the app. They are not customers. In the app, Morning Basket is one shared course, and one check counts it for every child (left). Checks also fill in attendance and hours (right). These are real screens from a pre-release build.



Plan, week view



Attendance and hours



Your next step

Join the launch list: go to myhomeschoolscribe.com/join and tap "Tell me when it launches". Got this kit from a friend? Same link.

iPhone and iPad only, for now. No Android or web version.

myhomeschoolscribe.com/join

HomeSchool Scribe is a homeschool planner and record keeper for iPhone and iPad. It launches on the US App Store on January 5, 2027. Screens are from a pre-release build and may change.



**HomeSchool
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